

14.1 == and equals() method

== operator

- the **== operator** compares the *reference or memory location* of objects in a heap, whether they point to the same location or not.
- If values of String are same but memory location is different then '==' will return false.

equals() method

- **equals()** method compares the *content equality of two strings*.
- Memory location can be same or different but if value is same and equals method is used then it will return true value.

Code snippet

```
1 public class Demo {
2     public static void main(String[] args) {
3
4         String s1 = "JAVA";
5         String s2 = "JAVA";
6         String s3 = new String("JAVA");
7
8         System.out.println(s1 == s2);
9         System.out.println(s1 == s3);
10        System.out.println(s1.equals(s2));
11        System.out.println(s1.equals(s3));
12    }
13 }
14
15
16 output -
17 true
18 false
19 true
20 true
```

Conclusion

```
1 //using literals
2 String s = "abc";
3 String s1 = "abc";
4
5 //using new keyword
6 String s2 = new String("abc");
7 String s3 = new String("abc");
```

	'=='	equals()	Storage
using literals	true (s == s1)	true[s.equals(s1)]	SCP

using new	false(s2==s3)	true[s2.equals(s3)]	
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